

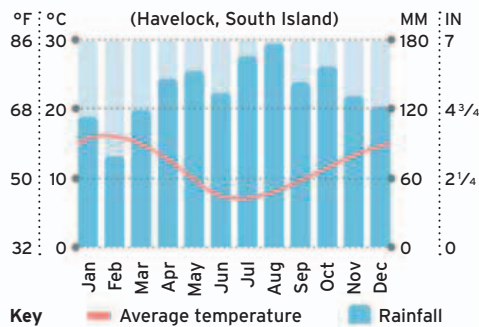
LOCATION

Most mixed forest cover is found on South Island, apart from the drier east, and the north of North Island.



CLIMATE

The mild maritime climate ensures appreciable rainfall every month, even in midsummer, while temperatures dip in winter.



Lesser short-tailed bat

Mystacina tuberculata

The lesser short-tailed bat spends about 30 percent of its feeding time foraging among deep leaf litter on the forest floor. The talons on the claws of its thumbs and feet aid its agility on the ground.

▽ GROUND FEEDER

The short-tailed bat's folded wings are protected from damage by a leathery sheath when it moves on the ground.



Welcome swallow

Hirundo neoxena



Australia's familiar rural and suburban swallow remains all year in most of its range. Unlike swifts, it perches on wires and bare branches, but it is a harvester of airborne insects, swerving elegantly at low level in pursuit of flies, and rising higher in humid conditions.



◁ FEEDING TIME

Chicks from nests in sheds and car ports line up on wires, and call out to be fed whenever a parent appears.

